

## Pushpam HandsPC 1100

## An eye for insurance

The 1100 comes with a leather pouch, and it sports a decent build quality. There are a total of seven buttons. Like the 1600, this PDA has preloaded applications for insurance agents.

The HandsPC 1100 is powered by a Motorola Dragonball EZ 16 MHz processor with 4 MB of ROM and 8 MB of RAM. This is too little, but given the number of applications that come preloaded, the space is sufficient. However, if new applications are installed, you will need to delete older applications to accommodate them.

The Infra-red port makes transferring notes and scheduling from either a PC or a cell phone easy.

The stylus bundled with this PDA has a full plastic body, and a smooth tip that provides ample grip. We did find it little difficult to get the proper characters without following the format specified in the manual. Downloading an application from the PC was very easy—a matter of a few clicks. This unit showed hardly any drop in battery power when kept on for more than 7 hours.

In all, this is a good PDA, but Pushpam needs to reduce the price, as there are many models in the grey market that can do all

the functions at a much lower price point. However, insurance agents will find it useful because of the customised software.

**Price:** Rs 11,000

- + Good battery life

- Expensive compared to feature set

## Conclusion

Penbex has minimal support as far as third-party application availability is concerned, so it's not something we'd recommend; both the Palm OS and Windows Pocket PC platforms enjoy enormous application support, and quite a few applications can be downloaded for free as well. Two PDAs that stood out were the Palm Zire 71 and the Toshiba Pocket PC e350; both colour, running the latest versions of Palm OS and Windows Pocket PC, respectively. Though the e350 has a faster processor and more memory, it is also comparatively expensive. The deciding feature was the Zire 71's built-in camera, and that's the one we recommend. 

DEEPAK DHINGRA *deepak\_dhingra@thinkdigit.com*

AHMED SHAIKH [ahmed\\_shaikh@thinkdigit.com](mailto:ahmed_shaikh@thinkdigit.com)

| CATEGORY              |                               | PDAs                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                               |                                                                  |                                                                          |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Brand                 | Palm                          | Palm                                                             | Toshiba                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Pushpam                                                                                                                                                                | Pushpam                                                                                       | Pushpam                                                          |                                                                          |
|                       | Model                         | Zire                                                             | Zire 71                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Pocket PC e350                                                                                                                                                         | handsPC 1600                                                                                  | handsPC 1300                                                     | handsPC 1100                                                             |
| CPU / MEMORY / SCREEN | CPU Speed (MHz)               | 16 MHz                                                           | 144 MHz                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | 300 MHz                                                                                                                                                                | 33 MHz                                                                                        | 33 MHz                                                           | 16 MHz                                                                   |
|                       | CPU Type                      | Motorola Dragonball EZ                                           | Texas Instruments OMAP310                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Intel PXA255 (XScale)                                                                                                                                                  | Motorola Dragonball VZ                                                                        | Motorola Dragonball VZ328                                        | Motorola Dragonball EZ                                                   |
|                       | ROM                           | 2 MB                                                             | 16 MB                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | 16 MB                                                                                                                                                                  | 4 MB                                                                                          | 4 MB                                                             | 4 MB                                                                     |
|                       | RAM                           | 2 MB                                                             | 16 MB                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | 64 MB                                                                                                                                                                  | 8 MB                                                                                          | 16 MB                                                            | 8 MB                                                                     |
|                       | Screen                        |                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                               |                                                                  |                                                                          |
|                       | Touchscreen                   | ✓                                                                | ✓                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | ✓                                                                                                                                                                      | ✓                                                                                             | ✓                                                                | ✓                                                                        |
|                       | Backlight                     | ✗                                                                | ✓                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | ✓                                                                                                                                                                      | ✓                                                                                             | ✓                                                                | ✗                                                                        |
|                       | Colours                       | Greyscale                                                        | 16-bit                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | 16-bit                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                               | Greyscale                                                        | Greyscale                                                                |
|                       | Diagonal Screen Size (inches) |                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | 3.5                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                               |                                                                  |                                                                          |
| Screen Size (pixels)  | 160 x 160                     | 320 x 320                                                        | 240 x 320                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | 160 x 160                                                                                                                                                              | 160 x 160                                                                                     | 160 x 160                                                        |                                                                          |
| STORAGE / EXPANSION   | Compact Flash Slot:           | ✗                                                                | ✗                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | ✗                                                                                                                                                                      | ✓                                                                                             | ✓                                                                | ✗                                                                        |
|                       | SD Card Slot                  | ✗                                                                | ✓                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | ✓                                                                                                                                                                      | ✗                                                                                             | ✗                                                                | ✗                                                                        |
|                       | Connectivity                  |                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                               |                                                                  |                                                                          |
|                       | IRDA                          | ✓                                                                | ✓                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | ✓                                                                                                                                                                      | ✓                                                                                             | ✓                                                                | ✓                                                                        |
|                       | Modem                         | ✗                                                                | ✗                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | ✗                                                                                                                                                                      | ✗                                                                                             | ✗                                                                | ✗                                                                        |
|                       | Bluetooth                     | ✗                                                                | ✗                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | ✗                                                                                                                                                                      | ✗                                                                                             | ✗                                                                | ✗                                                                        |
|                       | VGA Port                      | ✗                                                                | ✗                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | ✗                                                                                                                                                                      | ✗                                                                                             | ✗                                                                | ✗                                                                        |
| USB                   | ✓                             | ✓                                                                | ✓                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | ✗                                                                                                                                                                      | ✗                                                                                             | ✗                                                                |                                                                          |
| SOFTWARE              | Operating System              | Palm OS 4.1                                                      | Palm OS 5.2.1                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Microsoft Pocket                                                                                                                                                       | Penbex OS                                                                                     | Penbex OS                                                        | Penbex OS                                                                |
|                       | Applications                  | Address Book, Date Book, Clock, To Do List, Memo Pad, Calculator | SMS, To Do, Expense, HotSync, Memo Pad, Note Pad, Card Info, Date Book, Solitaire, Calculator, Palm Photos, Palm Reader, World clock, Address Book, AudiblePlayer, Kinoma Player, RealOne Player, Kinoma Producer, Palm VersaMail 2.5, PowerOne Calculator, Adobe Acrobat Reader for Palm OS | PC 2003 Pocket Word; Pocket Excel; Pocket Outlook; Windows Media Player 8 for Pocket PC; Calculator; Solitaire; Acrobat Reader for Pocket PC; Pocket Internet Explorer | Address Book, Date Book, Clock, To Do List, Note Pad, Calculator, Games, MP3 player, Recorder | Address Book, Date Book, Clock, To Do List, Note Pad, Calculator | Address Book, Date Book, Clock, To Do List, Note Pad, Calculator inbuilt |
| SIZE                  | Size (inches)                 | 4.4 x 2.9 x 0.6                                                  | 2.9 x 0.7 x 4.5                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | 3.1 x 4.9 x 0.5                                                                                                                                                        | 4.6 x 2.8 x 0.6                                                                               | 4.8 x 3.2 x 0.5                                                  | 4.6 x 3 x 0.6                                                            |
|                       | Weight (gms)                  | 108                                                              | 150                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | 149                                                                                                                                                                    | 120                                                                                           | 155                                                              | 140                                                                      |
|                       | Battery                       |                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                               |                                                                  |                                                                          |
| OTHERS                | Battery Type                  | Li-ion                                                           | Li-Polymer                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Li-ion                                                                                                                                                                 | Li-Polymer                                                                                    | Li-Polymer                                                       | Li-Polymer                                                               |
|                       | Extras                        |                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                               |                                                                  |                                                                          |
|                       | Speaker                       | ✓                                                                | ✓                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | ✓                                                                                                                                                                      | ✓                                                                                             | Buzzer                                                           | Buzzer                                                                   |
|                       | Camera                        | ✗                                                                | ✓                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | ✗                                                                                                                                                                      | ✗                                                                                             | ✗                                                                | ✗                                                                        |
|                       | Options                       |                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                               |                                                                  |                                                                          |
|                       | Docking Station               | ✗                                                                | ✓                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | ✓                                                                                                                                                                      | ✗                                                                                             | ✗                                                                | ✗                                                                        |
|                       | Voice Recorder                | ✗                                                                | ✗                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | ✓                                                                                                                                                                      | ✓                                                                                             | ✗                                                                | ✗                                                                        |
|                       | Headphone Jack                | ✗                                                                | ✓                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | ✓                                                                                                                                                                      | ✓                                                                                             | ✗                                                                | ✗                                                                        |
|                       | Price (Rs)                    | 7,500                                                            | 23,000                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | 29,990                                                                                                                                                                 | 14,700                                                                                        | 12,400                                                           | 11,000                                                                   |